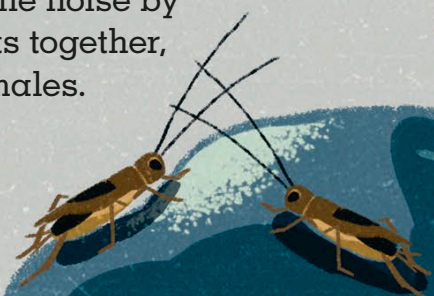


An Australian owl with large, dark eyes and brown and white feathers is perched on a dark, leafless branch. The background is a dark blue night sky with a large, pale moon and several small, bright stars. The owl is looking directly at the viewer.

Flying Fiends

Many nocturnal birds are fierce hunters that swoop down to catch prey on the ground. The Australian owl-nightjar catches crickets and ants that emerge after sunset.

Two crickets are on a dark, rounded rock. One cricket is on the left, facing right, and the other is on the right, facing left. They are both yellow and black with long antennae.

Singing insects

High-pitched chirping sounds can fill the night. Insects such as crickets make the noise by rubbing body parts together, often to attract females.

A line of four bull ants is walking from left to right across a light-colored ground. They are dark brown with long antennae and legs.

Bull ants forage for food between dusk and dawn.

A tall, green cactus with several vertical ribs is shown. At the top, a large, bright yellow flower with many petals is in bloom. The cactus has small, dark, cross-shaped marks along its ribs.

Night-blooming flowers

Some cacti only bloom at night. The flowers attract winged creatures that carry pollen to other flowers, which need the pollen to make seeds.